Revision Date:
07/01/2020

Background:
Individuals participating in CalWORKs Employment Services (ES) are required to provide relevant information during Appraisal or regular case management in order to be assigned to appropriate ES activities. This may include information relating to physical and behavioral health, including, but not limited to, mental health and substance use issues, past or present domestic abuse issues or any other barrier that may affect an individual's ability to participate in work activities.

Purpose:
The purpose of this material is to streamline and consolidate policies and procedures for Mental Health Services (MHS) and Substance Abuse Services (SAS), previously outlined in CPG 10-011.D and 10-011.E, under a new section entitled Behavioral Health Services (BHS).

Policy:
BHS Referral and Assignment
ES participants can be referred to BHS as needed to address concerns impairing their ability to participate in assigned activities. BHS participants may be referred to MHS, SAS and/or Family Violence Services (FVS). Policies and procedures pertaining to FVS are found in CPG 40-100.O and Processing Guides 40-100.O1-O3.

BHS may be assigned as an Initial Engagement activity at time of Appraisal for a period of four consecutive weeks (CPG 10-005.E). If it is determined that BHS activities are needed in excess of the initial four consecutive weeks, or at any time, the ECM will refer the individual to an Assessment/Reassessment and assign additional BHS activities on an ES plan.

ES Plan for BHS
The ES plan will include BHS activities determined as a result of the BHS assessment, including those related to a secondary diagnosis, appropriate employment accommodations or restrictions, supportive services and treatment requirements. Any prior diagnosis, evaluation, or assessment provided by the participant will also be considered in the development the ES plan.

Noncompliance with BHS
When the Employment Case Manager (ECM) determines that a participant in BHS activities is out of compliance with program requirements, the determination of whether the participant has good cause for Noncompliance will include consideration of whether the participant's BHS issue caused or substantially contributed to the failure to comply. The ECM will consult with the BHS provider to make this determination.

Procedure:
Processing Guide 10-011.B

References:
MPP 42-711, 42-716

Sunset Date:
This policy will be reviewed for continuance by 07/31/2023

Approval for Release:
7-20-20
Rick Warne, Director
Eligibility Operations